Thorough Purification of Offerings

Dakṣiṇāpariśodhanī · Toh 1011 · Derge Kangyur
ཡན་ཡངས་ས་སྦྱོང་བ་ཞེས་བྱ།

The Thorough Purification of Offerings, known in Sanskrit as the Dakṣiṇāpariśodhanī and in Tibetan as Yon yongs su sbyong ba, is a brief dhāraṇī text concerned with purifying the offerings that donors make to the religious community. After paying homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas, to the tathāgata Samantaprabharāja, and to the bodhisattva Mañjuśrīkumārabhūta, it presents a short incantation whose recitation, even once, is said to purify all misdeeds and cleanse offerings that need purifying. It goes on to explain that this practice causes the donor's offerings, and the merit accumulated through them, to increase. The work is Toh 1011 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collection of dhāraṇīs, the short incantations and their accompanying instructions preserved in the tantra section of the canon.

In the language of India: dakṣiṇī pariśodhanī nāma
In the language of Tibet: Thorough Purification of Offerings.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas!

Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Samantaprabharāja!

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, endowed with great compassion and endowed with wisdom, Mañjuśrīkumārabhūta!

namaḥ smanta brabhā rājāya tathāgatāya arta te bhyaḥ samyaksaṃbuddhāya namo mañjuśriye kumāra btātāya bodhisatvaya mahā satvāya mahākāruṇikāya tadyathā oṃ nirālampe nirābhāse jaye jayalabdhe mahāmāte dakṣe dakṣīṇīme barīśodhāya svāhā

By reciting this even once, all misdeeds will be purified. Many offerings that need purifying will also be purified. The offerings of that donor will increase, and all the accumulations will be brought to completion. By reciting this, no obstacles whatsoever will arise.

The Dhāraṇī for the Thorough Purification of Offerings, drawn from the Sūtra of Ascertainment in the Vinaya scriptures, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "Offerings" renders □□□ (Skt. dakṣiṇā), the gifts given by a donor to monks or to the Saṅgha. The dhāraṇī purifies these gifts so that the recipients can accept them without fault and the donor's merit increases. The source named in the colophon is probably a Vinaya text on ascertainment, perhaps related to the Vinayaviniścaya. I have kept the title descriptive because I cannot identify it securely. Mañjuśrīkumārabhūta means "Mañjuśrī, who has become a youth" (the youthful Mañjuśrī); the dhāraṇī itself addresses him as mañjuśriye kumāra[bhū]tāya.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.